

DEATH OF THE DINOSAURS



We can tell how old dinosaur fossils are by looking at the age of the rock they were found in. From this, we know that the last of the giant dinosaurs died out about 66 million years ago. Perhaps a huge disaster wiped them all out in one shot.

Rock-solid proof

Many rocks on the Earth's surface are formed in layers. The deeper the layer, the older the rock. No fossil of a big dinosaur has been found above the layer that formed 66 million years ago. This proves they died out this long ago.

From outer space

An enormous asteroid crashed into Earth 66 million years ago. It hit what is now part of Mexico, and the huge impact of the asteroid could have caused catastrophic climate change that made life impossible for the giant dinosaurs.



The asteroid may have hurtled toward Earth at about 40,000 miles (64,000 kilometers) per hour.